

Aria Golestani

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Academic Position

SSRC Criminal Justice Innovation Postdoctoral Fellow

2024 – present

Affiliations

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, University of Toronto, 2025 –

Visiting Research Scholar, Cornell University, 2024 – 2025.

Research Subject-Matter Expert (R-SME), Campaign Zero, 2022 –

Previous Employment and Visiting

Postdoctoral Fellow, Northeastern University, 2022 – 2024.

Centre for Economic Performance (CEP) at the London School of Economics and Political Science, June 2024.

Education

Ph.D. Economics, University of California, Irvine, 2022.

M.A. Economics, California State University Los Angeles, 2015.

B.A. Economics, University of Tehran, 2011.

Research Interests

Economics of Crime and Criminal Justice, Public Economics, Labor Economics

Publications

1. **Specialization in Criminal Courts: Decision Making, Recidivism, and Re-victimization in Domestic Violence Courts in Tennessee**
Aria Golestani, Emily Owens, Kerri Raissian
Journal of Human Resources, 2026
2. **How Is the Worker's Weekly Hour Related To Wage Over The Life Cycle? The U.S. evidence**
Aria Golestani, Madhu Mohanty
Applied Economics, 2017

Working Papers

1. **Affordable Housing Construction and Local Public Safety: Evidence from Los Angeles**
Aria Golestani, Taylor Mackay, Matthew Ross
Preparing for Submission, Draft Available
2. **Policing and Prosecuting Drug Offenses in Nashville: Drug Free School Zones**
Aria Golestani, Yoonjung Kim, Jaclyn Rosenquist
Preparing for Submission, Draft Available
3. **Silenced: Consequences of the Nuisance Property Ordinances**
Aria Golestani
Preparing for Submission, Draft Available
4. **Nothing Stops a Bullet like a Job? The Long-Term Impact of Summer Youth Employment Programs on Criminal Justice Involvement**
Alicia Sasser Modestino, Aria Golestani, Brandon Turchan, Sebastian Ramirez, Benjamin Struhl, Anthony A. Braga
Preparing for Submission, Draft Available

Work in Progress

1. **How Important is Police Testimony for DV Convictions? Evidence from Crawford v Washington**
Aria Golestani, Emily Owens, Kerri Raissian
2. **Do Domestic Violence Lethality Assessment Programs Improve Criminal Justice Outcomes? Evidence from Linked Administrative Data Sources**
Aria Golestani, Lauren Magee, Susan Parker
3. **The Impact of Retaliatory Violence on Homicide Clearance Rates**
Aria Golestani, Zach Porreca

Awards, Grants, & Fellowships

The Laura and John Arnold Foundation (Co-PI with Emily Owens and Kerri Raissian. \$204,000) "How Important is Police Testimony for DV Convictions?"	2026-2028
The Laura and John Arnold Foundation Workshop Grant (with Magdalena Dominguez. \$36,240) WEC Junior Workshop	2026
The Laura and John Arnold Foundation Workshop Grant (with Magdalena Dominguez and Emma Rackstraw. \$55,300) WEC Junior Workshop	2025
The Laura and John Arnold Foundation Workshop Grant (with Magdalena Dominguez. \$30,500) WEC Junior Workshop	2024

Charles A. Lave Paper Prize Award	2022
California Policy Lab Graduate Fellowships	2021
Outstanding Poster Award, All-California Labor Economics Conference	2021
Social Sciences Graduate Students Fellowship, UC Irvine	2021 – 2022
Graduate Division Completion Fellowship, UC Irvine	2021 – 2022
UCI Inclusive Excellence Ambassador Fellowship	2020 – 2021
Christian Werner Fellowship, School of Social Sciences, UC Irvine	2021
Economics Summer Research Fellowship, UCI	2018; 2019; 2020; 2021
Travel Grant, UC Irvine Department of Economics	2019
The Initiative to End Family Violence (IEFV) Graduate Fellowship	2018
Merit Fellowship in Economics, University of California, Irvine	2016 – 2021
Special Recognition in Graduate Studies, California State University, LA	2014; 2015
Leonard Mathy Fellowship in Economics, California State University, LA	2014

Academic & Professional Activities

Seminar Series and Conferences Organized

Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars (WEC Junior), co-organized with Magdalena Dominguez	2021–
ASSA: Economists who Stutter, co-organized with William Gale	2021
Grad Student Econ of Crime Online Seminar, co-organized with Jennifer Doleac	2020
UCI Crime and Risky Behavior Workshop, co-organized with Taylor Mackay	2018-2021

Invited Seminars and Conference Presentations

- 2025: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM), Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars (WEC Junior)
- 2024: 1st Workshop on Violence Against Women: Drivers and Policies (Barcelona Institute of Economics), Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)
- 2023: Western Economic Association International (WEIA)
- 2022: NBER Public Economics Program Meeting, Centre for Economic Performance Policing and Crime Workshop (LSE), Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM), Western Economic Association International (WEIA)
- 2021: Annual Meeting of the American Law and Economics Association (ALEA), Southern Economic Association Annual Conference (SEA) (*session co-organizer*), All-California Labor Economics Conference Graduate Student Poster Session (ACLEC), University of Chicago and London School of Economics Conference on the Economics of Crime and Justice (*by coauthor*), Society of Economics of the Household (SEHO), Society of Labor Economists (SOLE), Population Association of America Annual Meeting (PAA), Western Economic Association International Virtual Conference (WEIA), Association for Mentoring and Inclusion in Economics (AMIE)

2020: NBER Crime Summer Institute (*by coauthor*), Southern Economic Association Annual Conference (SEA) (*session co-organizer*), Grad Econ of Crime Online Seminar (*co-organizer*), UCI Labor-Public Seminar, Public Choice Society Annual Meeting (*accepted; canceled*)

2019: Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Conference, All-California Labor Economics Conference Graduate Student Poster Session (ACLEC), UCI Labor-Public Seminar, Initiative to End Family Violence Research Colloquium (UCI Law School)

Selected Participant & Workshop Scholarship

Association for Mentoring and Inclusion in Economics (AMIE)	2021
Research Staff Training at The Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL)	2020
IRES Graduate Student Workshop on The Economics of Religion and Identity	2018

Campus Service

UCI Inclusive Excellence Ambassador	2020 – 2021
Mentor, Econ Graduate Students Mentoring Program, UCI	2019 – 2021
UCI Department of Economics Graduate Council	2017 – 2021
The Economics Learning Center (ELC), UC Irvine, Supervisor	2017 – 2020

Press Coverage

Probable Causation Podcast, The San Francisco Standard

Referee Service

Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics, Journal of Labor Research, Poverty & Public Policy, International Criminal Justice Review

Teaching

Instructor of Record, Northeastern University, 2023

Principles of Microeconomics.

Teaching Assistant, University of California, Irvine, 2016-2021

Economic of Asymmetric Information, Global Economy, Basic Economics I and II, Intermediate Economics II, Money and Banking, Topics in Quantitative Methods, Applied Econometrics, Econ of Accounting Decisions.

Teaching Assistant, California State University, Los Angeles, 2014-2015

Market Indicators and Federal Reserve Policy, Managerial Economics, Principles of Macroeconomics, Applied Statistics, Current Issues in Latin America.

References

Professor Emily Owens
egowens@uci.edu
University of California, Irvine

Associate Professor Kerri Raissian
kerri.raissian@uconn.edu
University of Connecticut

Assistant Professor Bocar Ba
bocar.ba@duke.edu
Duke University

Associate Professor Alicia Modestino
a.modestino@neu.edu
Northeastern University

Associate Professor Matthew B. Ross
mbross.econ@gmail.com
Northeastern University